

President Murmu's Electrifying Republic Day Eve Speech Sets Nation Ablaze!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

President Droupadi Murmu on Sunday addressed the nation on the eve of 77th Republic Day.

Detailed analysis:

The address outlines the government's vision for defence self-reliance, social welfare and national integration—key topics for UPSC mains essays and interview questions on nation-building.

Source: <https://www.indiatvnews.com/news/india/president-droupadi-murmu-address-to-the-nation-live-updates-republic-day-2026-2026-01-25-1027432>

India's Elite Honoured: 45 Unsung Heroes Grab Padma Awards in Historic Reveal!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The list of Padma Awards recipients for 2026 was announced today as the country prepares to celebrate Republic Day 2026. The awards recognised 45 unsung heroes from across the country for their distinguished service.

Detailed analysis:

Understanding the sectors and personalities recognised helps candidates anticipate trend-based questions on social contributions, cultural heritage, and government recognition policies in the exam.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/77th-republic-day-padma-awards-2026-see-full-list-10883194#publisher=newsstand>

From Space to Valor: Shubhanshu Shukla Earns India's Highest Peacetime Gallantry Medal!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla, who created history by becoming the first Indian to visit the International Space Station (ISS), has been honoured with the Ashoka Chakra, India's highest peacetime gallantry award.

Detailed analysis:

The award underscores the nexus between scientific achievement and national security, a recurring theme in the GS-2 paper on science-technology and defence strategy.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/shubhanshu-shukla-1st-indian-to-set-foot-on-international-space-station-awarded-ashok-chakra-10883331#publisher=newsstand>

Delhi's Elite Special Cell Wins 13 Gallantry Medals After Thwarting Four Terror Plots!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Thirteen officers of Delhi Police's Special Cell have been awarded the Police Medal for Gallantry (PMG) on the 77th Republic Day for their role in four major high-risk counter-terror operations that neutralised major threats to the national capital.

Detailed analysis:

The commendation highlights India's internal security mechanisms, useful for answering questions on policing reforms, counter-terrorism, and the role of central forces in GS-3.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/4-anti-terror-ops-13-officers-gallantry-for-delhi-police-special-cell-10883101#publisher=newsstand>

Majestic Bactrian Camels March Through Capital – A First-Ever Republic Day Spectacle!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

In a historic first for the Republic Day Parade, two majestic doublehumped Bactrian camels, named Galwan and Nubra, will walk down Kartavya Path.

Detailed analysis:

The inclusion of camels symbolizes India's cultural diversity and border-region representation, a point often cited in essay topics on national integration and heritage.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/lehs-bactrian-camels-galwan-and-nubra-to-walk-down-delhis-kartavya-path-10882913#publisher=newsstand>

Diplomatic Fireworks! Jaishankar's Candid Talk With US Congress Reveals Indo-US Tug-of-War!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Sunday discussed with a three-member American Congressional delegation various aspects of India-US relations, including trade and security, against the backdrop of continuing strain in ties.

Detailed analysis:

Insights from this dialogue are vital for GS-2 preparation on foreign policy, especially India's strategic balancing act between the US, China, and regional partners.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/productive-but-complex-s-jaishankar-us-lawmakers-discuss-ties-10882180#publisher=newsstand>

Inferno Engulfs Karachi Mall, Hundreds Perish in Fiery Catastrophe

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A case has been registered over the massive fire incident at the complex that housed nearly 1,200 wholesale and retail shops spread over an area of 8,000 square feet

Detailed analysis:

The tragedy highlights glaring gaps in fire safety enforcement and emergency response in crowded commercial spaces. For exam takers, note the potential policy reforms on building codes and disaster management that may follow such incidents.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/karachi-fire-death-toll-crosses-seventy/article70549445.ece>

France to Lock Kids Offline: Macron Orders Nationwide Social Media Ban for Under-15s

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Emmanuel Macron's announcement came just days after the British government said it would consider banning young teenagers from social media

Detailed analysis:

The move reflects growing concerns over digital addiction and mental health among youth, and may set a precedent for other EU nations. Candidates should understand the balance between child protection and freedom of expression in policy debates.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/macron-pushes-for-fast-track-ban-on-social-media-for-children-under-15/article70549406.ece>

Iran Hails India as Hero for Defying 'Political Witch-hunt' at UN

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

UNHRC adopted a resolution extending the mandate of a fact-finding mission on Iran for two years, and also called for an urgent investigation of the protests which began on December 28, 2025

Detailed analysis:

India's vote underscores its strategic alignment with Iran and its stance against what it calls politicized human-rights inquiries. This episode is relevant for questions on India's foreign policy and multilateral diplomacy.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/unhrc-resolution-on-iran-protests-crackdown-india-vote-ambassador/article70548880.ece>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen kickstarted her four-day visit to India on Saturday (January 24, 2026)

Detailed analysis:

The visit aims to deepen trade ties, technology collaboration, and geopolitical cooperation amid China's growing influence. Aspirants should track potential agreements on green tech, defence, and services sectors.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/india-eu-delhi-summit-ursula-von-der-leyen-trade-deal/article70548659.ece>

Tri-Lateral Breakthrough: US Claims Russia-Ukraine 'Big Step' Towards Peace

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

UAE government spokesperson said the meetings, which involved top military officers from both sides, were held in a "constructive and positive atmosphere"

Detailed analysis:

The statement signals a possible de-escalation route via the UAE, highlighting the role of third-party mediation. Candidates should note the diplomatic channels and the impact on regional security calculations.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/us-ukraine-russia-trilateral-talks-uae/article70548661.ece>

WHO Chief Slams US Exit as 'Dangerous Lie' Undermining Global Health

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus warned that U.S. announcement this week that it had formally withdrawn from the WHO "makes both the U.S. and the world less safe"

Detailed analysis:

The criticism underscores the political dimension of global health governance and the potential setbacks for disease-control initiatives. For exams, focus on the implications for international cooperation and funding streams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/who-chief-says-reasons-us-gave-for-withdrawing-untrue/article70548660.ece>

Midnight Medicine Miracle: Blinkit's CEO Gets Doctor's Call Before Delivery!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A Bengaluru-based CEO has praised Blinkit after a late-night over-the-counter medicine order prompted a follow-up call from a doctor, even before the delivery arrived, sparking discussion online about evolving quick-commerce services.

Detailed analysis:

The incident highlights the growing importance of value-added services in quick-commerce. By integrating tele-health support, Blinkit differentiates itself, potentially increasing customer loyalty and average order value. Aspirants should note how logistics firms are moving up the value chain beyond speed to include ancillary services.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/trends/bengaluru-ceo-praises-blinkit-after-midnight-medicine-order-triggers-doctor-follow-up-call-11769354419292.html>

Shark Tank Showdown: Aman Gupta Destroys Anupam Mittal's '5 Million Users' Claim!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Aman Gupta and Anupam Mittal locked horns yet again on Shark Tank India 5 during an AI startup pitch, with Aman's on-air dig at Anupam's "five million users" claim quickly becoming one of the episode's most talked-about moments.

Detailed analysis:

The exchange underscores the critical scrutiny of user metrics in funding rounds. Investors are increasingly demanding verifiable data rather than aspirational numbers. For exam preparation, remember that credibility of traction is a key evaluation criterion in startup financing.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/trends/aman-gupta-mocks-anupam-mittal-s-user-database-claim-on-shark-tank-india-lehenge-thodi-bikenge-11769348668331.html>

Modi's 'Zero Defect, Zero Effect' Rally: India's Startup Engine Roars to 3rd Largest!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

In his monthly radio address, Prime Minister Modi urged “zero defect, zero effect” production, highlighted the surge in startups, and community-led initiatives.

Detailed analysis:

The address signals a policy push for high-quality manufacturing and reinforces India’s ranking in the global startup ecosystem. Aspirants should focus on how government incentives, quality standards, and ecosystem support can drive export competitiveness and attract foreign investment.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/pm-modi-pushes-quality-manufacturing-as-india-touts-third-largest-startup-ecosystem-11769338020758.html>

Iran-US Tension Triggers IndiGo Chaos: International Flights Scrubbed!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

IndiGo issued a travel advisory due to changes in flight schedules amid rising tensions between Iran and the US. Details here.

Detailed analysis:

Geopolitical risk directly translates into operational disruptions for airlines. IndiGo's pre-emptive cancellations illustrate the need for robust contingency planning. Business students should study how airlines hedge against political volatility through flexible routing and fuel-price hedging.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/world/iran-us-tensions-indigo-cancels-some-international-flights-issues-alerts-on-others-check-details-11769342336510.html>

Winter Fury Hits 17 US States: Power Outages, Flight Cancellations – Supply Chains Shudder!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The US faces historic winter weather as a storm triggers widespread power outages, disrupts travel, and impacts lakhs of population. Emergency disaster declarations cover 17 states, more than 500,000 homes are without electricity, and thousands of flights have been canceled.

Detailed analysis:

Severe weather events expose vulnerabilities in logistics and energy infrastructure. The cascade of power loss and flight cancellations can delay shipments, raise freight costs, and strain inventory buffers. Candidates should note the importance of supply-chain resilience and insurance mechanisms in such scenarios.

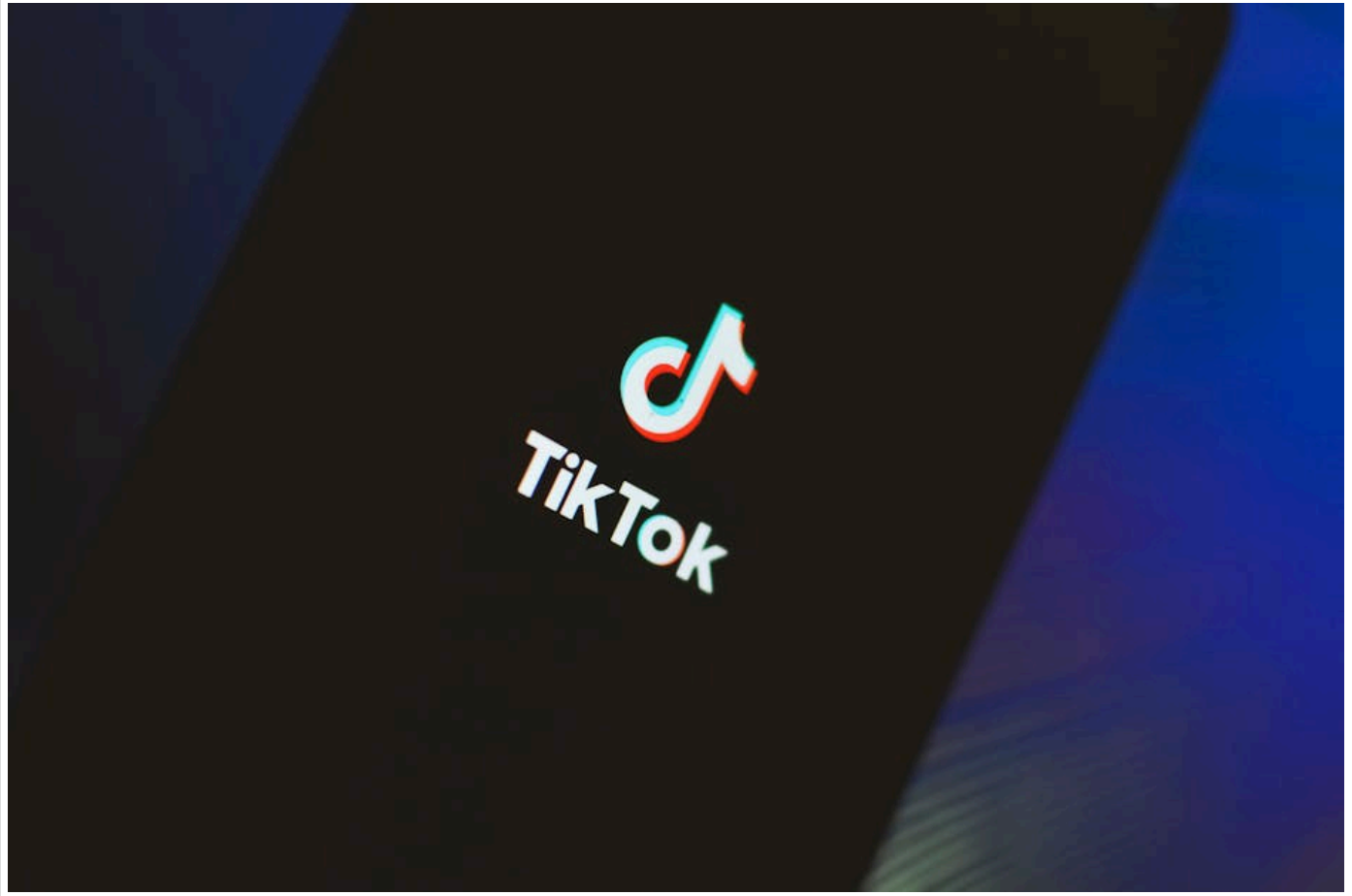
Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/us-winter-storm-emergencies-in-17-states-5-lakh-without-power-grids-strained-9-600-flights-cancelled-10-points-11769346121805.html>

TikTok Goes Dark: Millions Stuck, Brands Lose Reach – What's Next?

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

TikTok experienced a disruption on January 25, leaving users unable to refresh feeds or access key features. As complaints poured in on Downtetector, netizens took to X to share memes and vent their frustration.

Detailed analysis:

Platform reliability is crucial for digital advertisers. An outage can erode user engagement and disrupt ad impressions, prompting brands to diversify spend across platforms. For business exams, remember that platform risk management is a component of modern marketing strategy.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/trends/tiktok-outage-disrupts-feeds-in-us-netizens-flood-x-with-memes-now-i-have-to-pay-attention-to-my-tv-11769340388495.html>

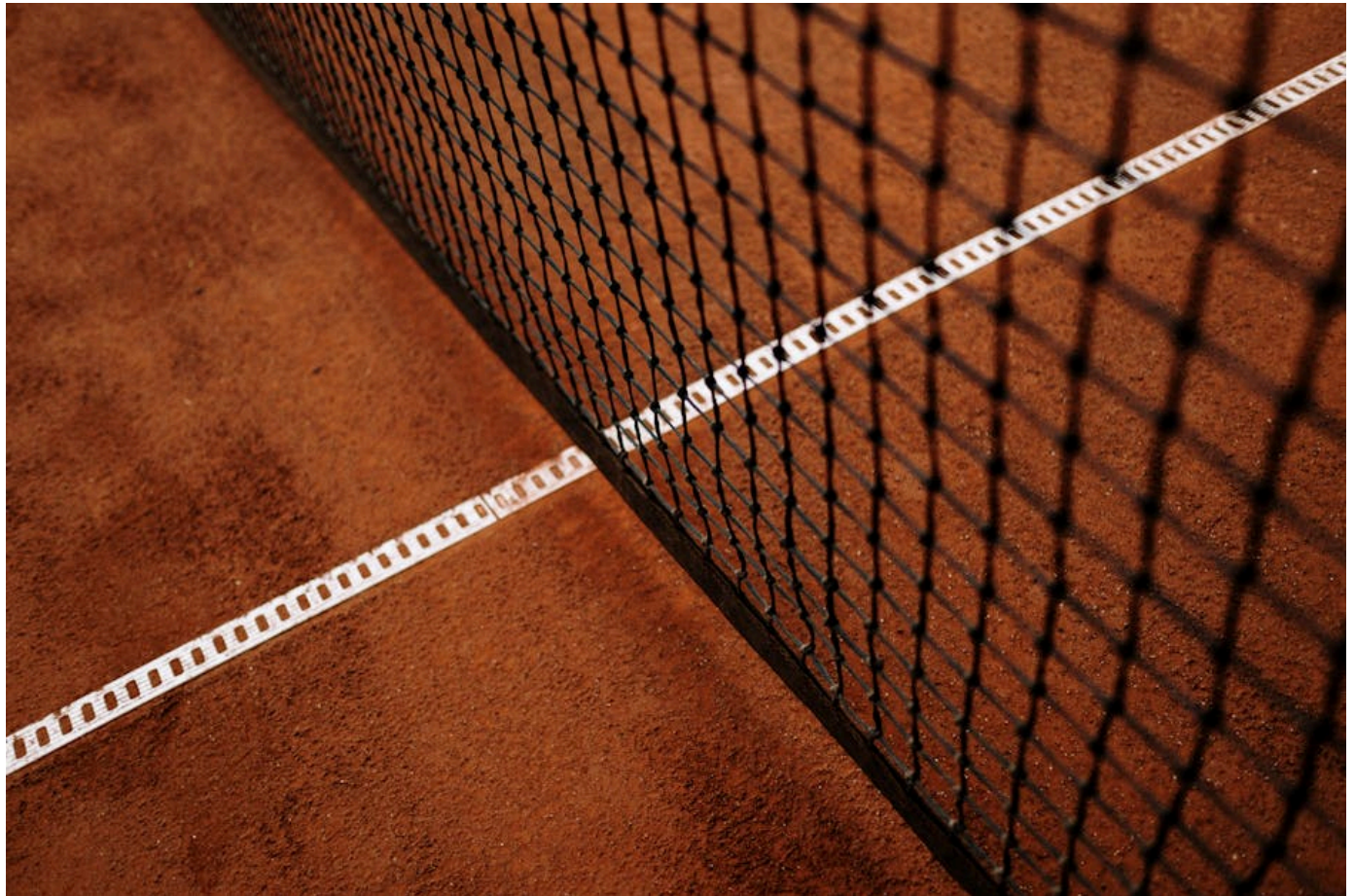
— SPORTS —

Alcaraz & Sabalenka Storm Australian Open Quarterfinals – A Tennis Tsunami!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Carlos Alcaraz and Aryna Sabalenka advance to the quarterfinals of the Australian Open, keeping alive their title hopes.

Detailed analysis:

Their progress highlights the new generation of tennis stars; Alcaraz aims for his first Grand Slam while Sabalenka seeks to cement her top-rank status. Important for exam questions on current sports achievements.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/tennis/alcaraz-eases-into-last-eight-in-bid-for-maiden-melbourne-title-sabalenka-powers-her-way-into-the-quarterfinals-101769321633390.html>

Rising Rocket Ben Shelton Set to Ignite Aussie Open Showdown!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Ben Shelton prepares to face 12th seed Casper Ruud after a strong run to the Australian Open fourth round.

Detailed analysis:

Shelton's aggressive playstyle and recent breakthrough make him a key contender for India's upcoming sports quizzes on emerging tennis talent.

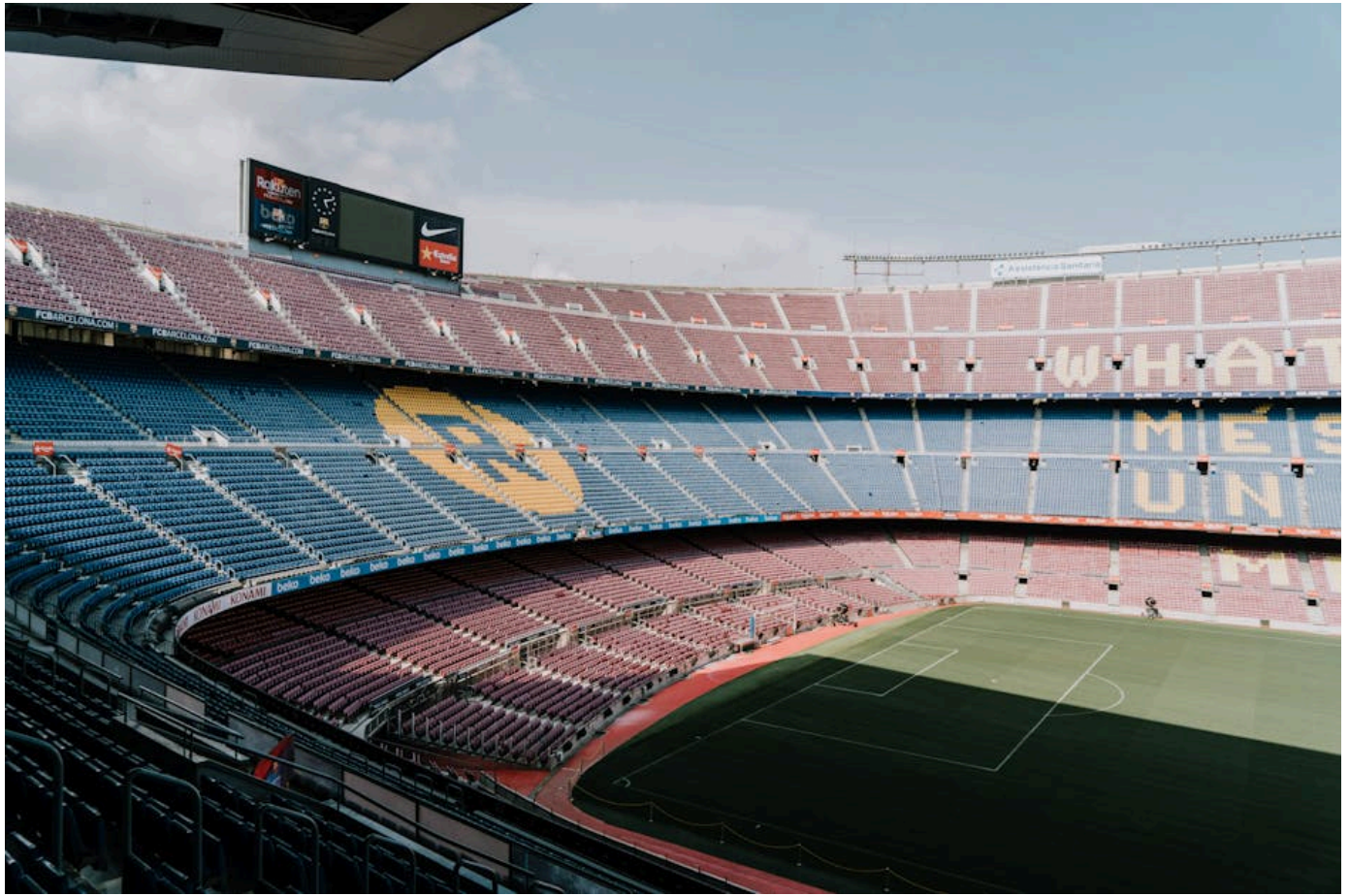
Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/tennis/big-stage-beckons-for-ben-shelton-after-australian-open-fourth-round-push-101769304243859.html>

Guardiola Blasts Ref Bias Yet Man City Roars On!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Pep Guardiola says Manchester City's recent victories come despite controversial refereeing decisions.

Detailed analysis:

The statement underscores the tactical resilience of City, a case study for sports management and ethics in competitive football, relevant for UPSC and other exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/man-city-success-despite-refereeing-calls-claims-guardiola-101769286560594.html>

Homecoming Hero: Mike McCarthy Set to Lead Steelers Back to Glory!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Mike McCarthy is in talks to become head coach of the Pittsburgh Steelers, returning to his hometown.

Detailed analysis:

A high-profile coaching move in the NFL, illustrating leadership changes and their impact on team performance – a useful example for sports administration topics.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/us-sports/steelers-and-mike-mccarthy-have-reached-a-verbal-agreement-for-mccarthy-to-coach-his-hometown-team-101769286492186.html>

Bad Bunny's Super Bowl Dress Drama Debunked – What's the Real Deal?

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

New details emerge clarifying rumors that Bad Bunny might wear a dress for his Super Bowl performance on February 8.

Detailed analysis:

Shows the intersection of pop culture and sports events, highlighting media hype management – a point of interest for general studies and media literacy sections.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/us-sports/biggest-bad-bunny-super-bowl-rumor-busted-new-details-revealed-amid-claims-he-will-wear-a-dress-101769299214112.html>

Suruchi Phogat's Secret Weapon: Patience to Conquer Asian Games & World Stage!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

After a sensational rise last year, Suruchi Phogat aims to bounce back from World Championships disappointment with strong trial scores.

Detailed analysis:

Her focus on mental fortitude is a classic lesson for sports psychology and preparation strategies, often featured in competitive exam questions on Indian athletes.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/others/patience-will-be-key-to-suruchi-phogat-s-game-in-asiad-worlds-year-101769353987820.html>

India's Bold Gamble to Wipe Out Malaria by 2030!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

What does the National Framework for Malaria Elimination in India lay down? From 2015-2023, by what percentage has malaria cases reduced in India? What is the protocol for testing, treating and tracking the disease? What does the World Malaria Report 2025 state?

Detailed analysis:

The article outlines the government's target to eradicate malaria by 2030, a key topic for UPSC and other competitive exams under Health & Family Welfare. Candidates should note: (1) the National Framework for Malaria Elimination (2024-2030) and its five strategic pillars; (2) a 78% decline in malaria cases from 2015 to 2023, as per NMCP data; (3) the 'Test-Treat-Track' (T3) protocol involving rapid diagnostic tests, ACTs, and a digital surveillance platform; (4) the World Malaria Report 2025 highlights India's contribution to the global decline and the remaining challenge of drug-resistant strains in the

northeastern states. Remember these figures and strategies for answer writing in the Health & Family Welfare section and for interview questions on public-health initiatives.

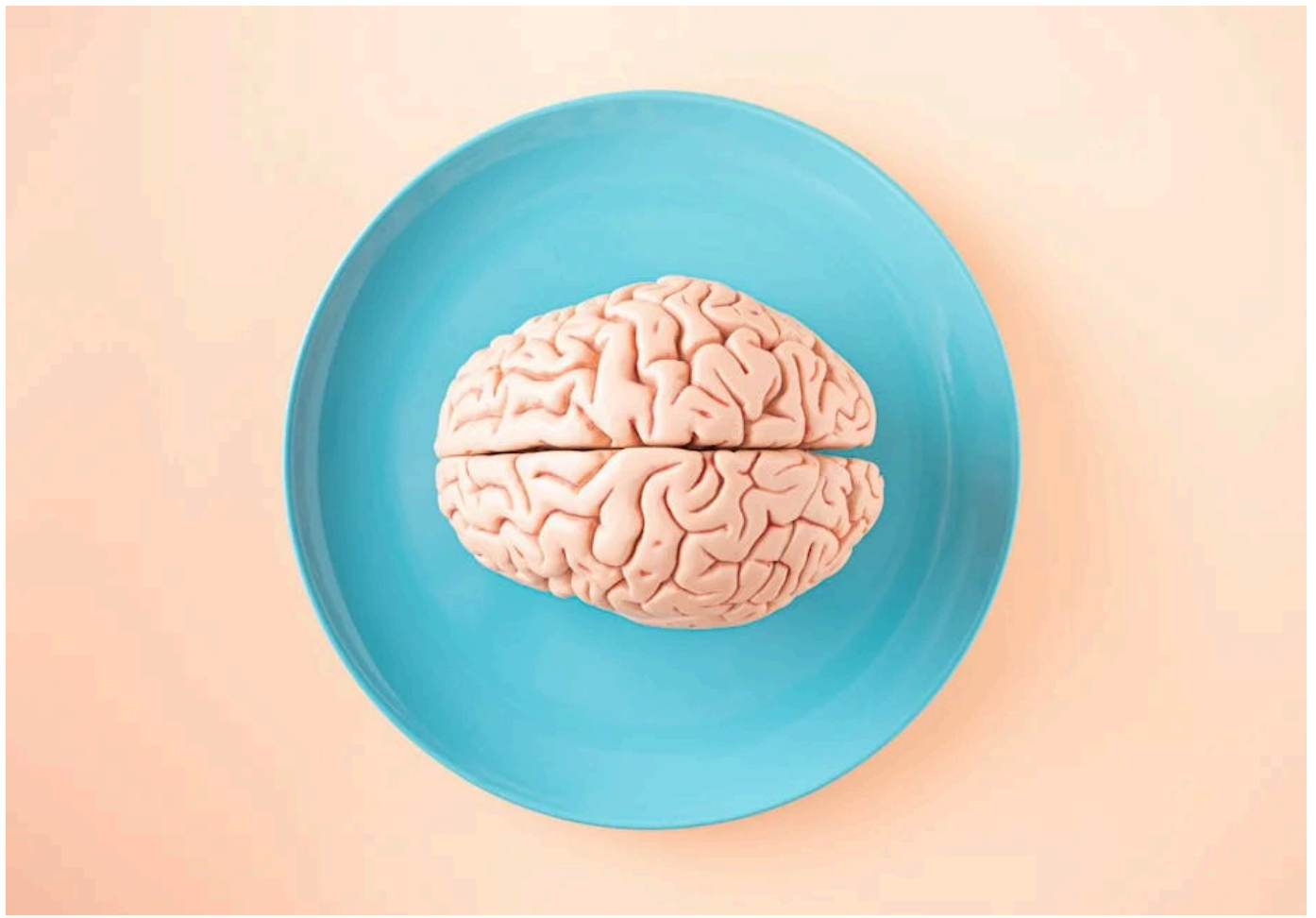
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/can-india-eliminate-malaria-by-2030-explained/article70547357.ece>

Turn Your Brain into a Muscle: Neurologist Reveals Secret Training Hacks!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Your brain is not passively wearing down with age. It is constantly remodeling itself in response to how you use it

Detailed analysis:

Highlights neuroplasticity and lifestyle interventions—key topics for preventive health questions in UPSC and state exams. Understanding brain-training can also aid PGME and allied-health curricula.

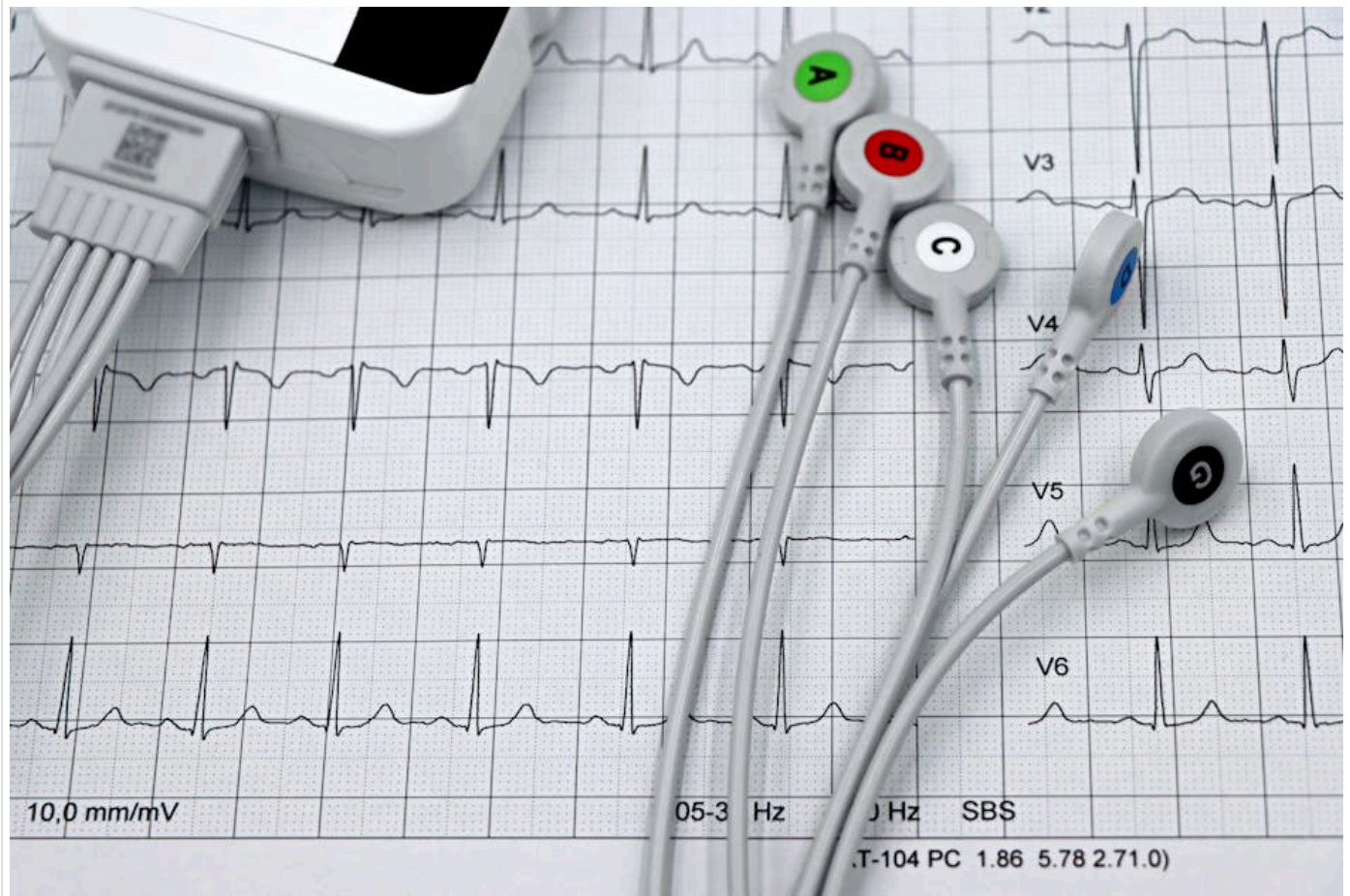
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/your-brain-can-be-trained-much-like-your-muscles-a-neurologist-explains-how-to-boost-your-brain-health/article70549439.ece>

Pregnant Hearts Under Attack: Alarming Rise in Maternal Heart Crises!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Heart attacks during pregnancy are rare, but are on the rise now due to factors such as increased age, diabetes and obesity; it is crucial for women to be aware of this phenomenon to ensure early diagnosis and timely treatment

Detailed analysis:

Combines obstetrics with cardiology—an interdisciplinary area often tested in AIIMS/NEET-PG. Emphasizes risk-factor screening and emergency management for pregnant women, aligning with national maternal health programs.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/what-is-behind-the-increasing-number-of-heart-attacks-in-pregnancy/article70537077.ece>

New Study Demands Massive Public Health Funding to Slash Household Medical Bills!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The research shows that rising incomes and rapid urbanisation are closely linked to higher healthcare consumption, while education and longevity also influence spending patterns, particularly private OOP expenses

Detailed analysis:

Directly relevant to health-economics and policy-making sections of the civil services syllabus. Illustrates the fiscal link between public health investment and out-of-pocket expenditure, supporting arguments for increased budgetary allocations.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/new-study-calls-for-higher-allocation-for-public-health-to-lower-household-medical-expenses/article70549438.ece>

India's Bold Goal: Eradicate Malaria by 2030 – Is It Within Reach?

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

What does the National Framework for Malaria Elimination in India lay down? From 2015-2023, by what percentage has malaria cases reduced in India? What is the protocol for testing, treating and tracking the disease? What does the World Malaria Report 2025 state?

Detailed analysis:

Fits the infectious-disease and public-health modules of UPSC and state exams. Provides data on trends, national framework, and WHO targets—useful for answer writing on disease control strategies and vector-borne disease management.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/can-india-eliminate-malaria-by-2030-explained/article70547357.ece>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The National Health Policy 2017 set a clear direction and measurable milestones. By 2026, India had advanced on several fronts, missed others, and encountered risks that were not fully imagined in 2017. The lesson is that programmes, financing, and measurement must move together

Detailed analysis:

Critical for understanding health-policy evaluation—an essential component of the Governance & Administration paper. Highlights gaps between policy intent and implementation, useful for essay questions on health sector reforms.

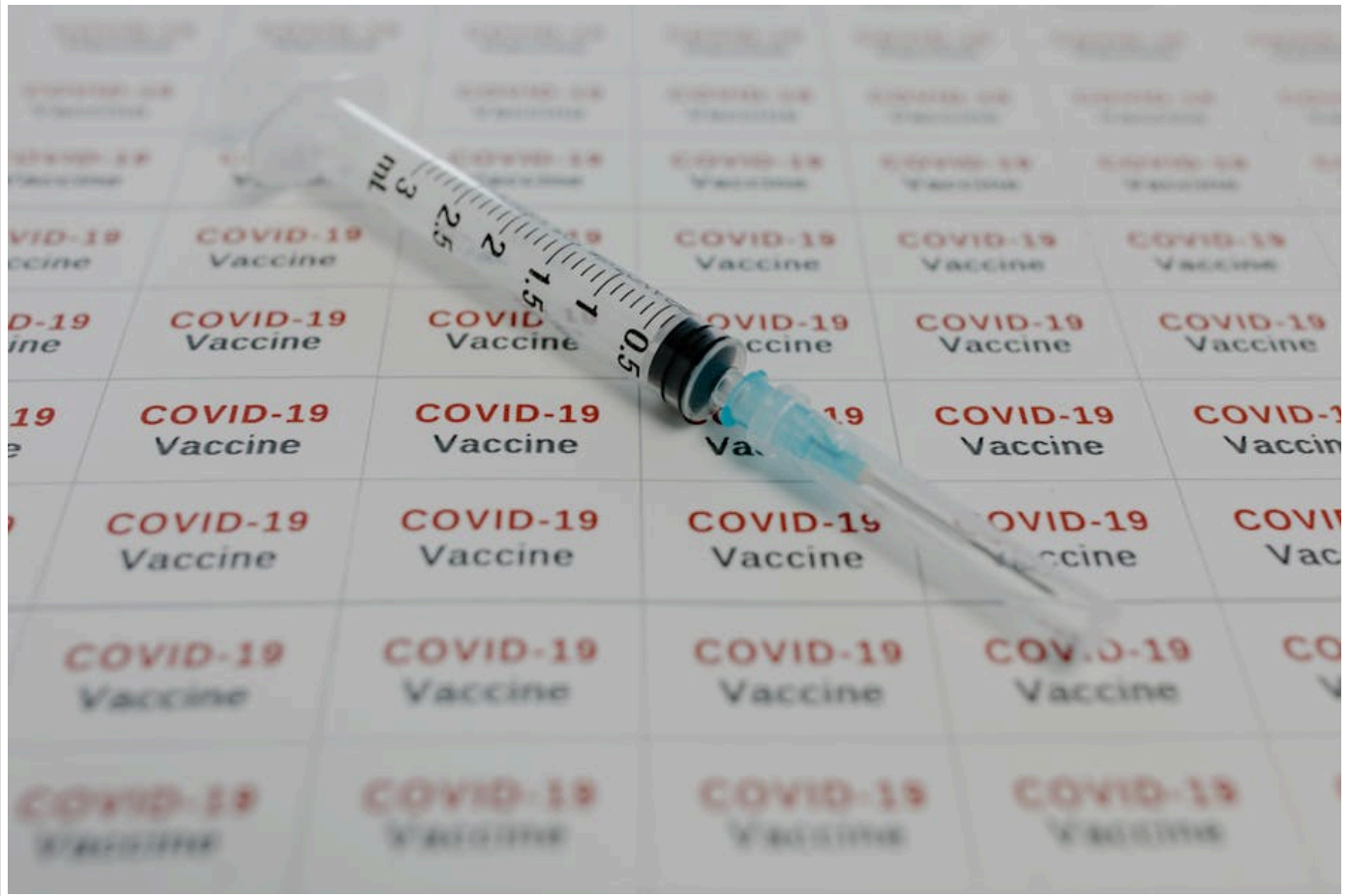
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/why-it-is-time-to-audit-indias-national-health-policy-2017/article70528959.ece>

HPV Vaccine Isn't a Free Pass – Pap Smears Still Crucial!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The HPV vaccine does not replace Pap smears. Vaccination and screening must go hand in hand. The HPV vaccine protects against the most common high-risk strains of the virus that cause cervical cancer, but this means there remains a small but significant risk of cervical cell changes even after vaccination.

Detailed analysis:

Relevant for community medicine and preventive health sections. Reinforces the dual strategy of immunization plus screening—frequently asked in MCQs on cervical cancer control and in essay topics on women's health initiatives.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/the-hpv-vaccine-is-not-a-free-pass-why-regular-pap-smears-still-matter/article70514306.ece>

— EDUCATION —

UPSC's Shocking New Cadre Rules Unveiled!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Union Public Service Commission releases a concise guide on its revamped cadre allocation system for 2026, outlining ten crucial changes for aspirants.

Detailed analysis:

Understanding the new cadre policy is vital for UPSC candidates to strategize service preferences and maximize their chances of securing desired posts.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/upsc-2026-new-cadre-allocation-policy-explained-all-you-need-to-know-10493406/>

JEE Main Secrets: How Jan-21-24 Papers Reveal Winning Strategies!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

An analysis of the JEE Main 2026 papers conducted between Jan 21-24, highlighting patterns, difficulty levels, and key topics that candidates should focus on.

Detailed analysis:

Provides actionable insights for future JEE aspirants, helping them prioritize study topics and improve scoring tactics for upcoming exams.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/jee-main-2026-what-aspirants-can-learn-from-jee-main-papers-held-from-jan-21-to-24-10488843/>

IIT Delhi Invades Kota: Open House Sparks JEE Fever!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

IIT Delhi announces an open-house event in Kota, offering direct interaction with faculty and guidance for JEE Main 2026 hopefuls.

Detailed analysis:

Kota being a coaching hub, this event gives aspirants firsthand exposure to IIT expectations, aiding informed preparation and college choice.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/iit-delhi-to-conduct-open-house-jee-main-2026-advanced-10493596/>

Sky-High Careers: IAF Opens 2027 Agniveervayu Registrations!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Indian Air Force launches the Agniveervayu recruitment drive for the 2027 intake, detailing eligibility criteria and application procedures.

Detailed analysis:

Crucial for defence-service aspirants; early registration information helps candidates plan academics, physical training, and documentation to secure a coveted IAF slot.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/iaf-agniveervayu-registration-2027-intake-iafreruitment-edcil-co-in-10493985/>

KVS Hunts Teachers: Massive 2026 Special Educator Vacancies!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan releases recruitment notices for Special Educator positions, covering TGT and PRT posts across India.

Detailed analysis:

Teaching jobs in KVS are highly sought after; the announcement offers a clear pathway for education graduates aiming for stable government positions.

Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/kvs-recruitment-2026-special-educator-vacancies-kvsangathan-nic-in-10493745/>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister urges Prime Minister Modi to exclude NEET scores from BPT and BOT admissions, citing logical inconsistencies.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights ongoing policy debates affecting medical and allied health admissions, essential for NEET aspirants to monitor potential changes in eligibility criteria.

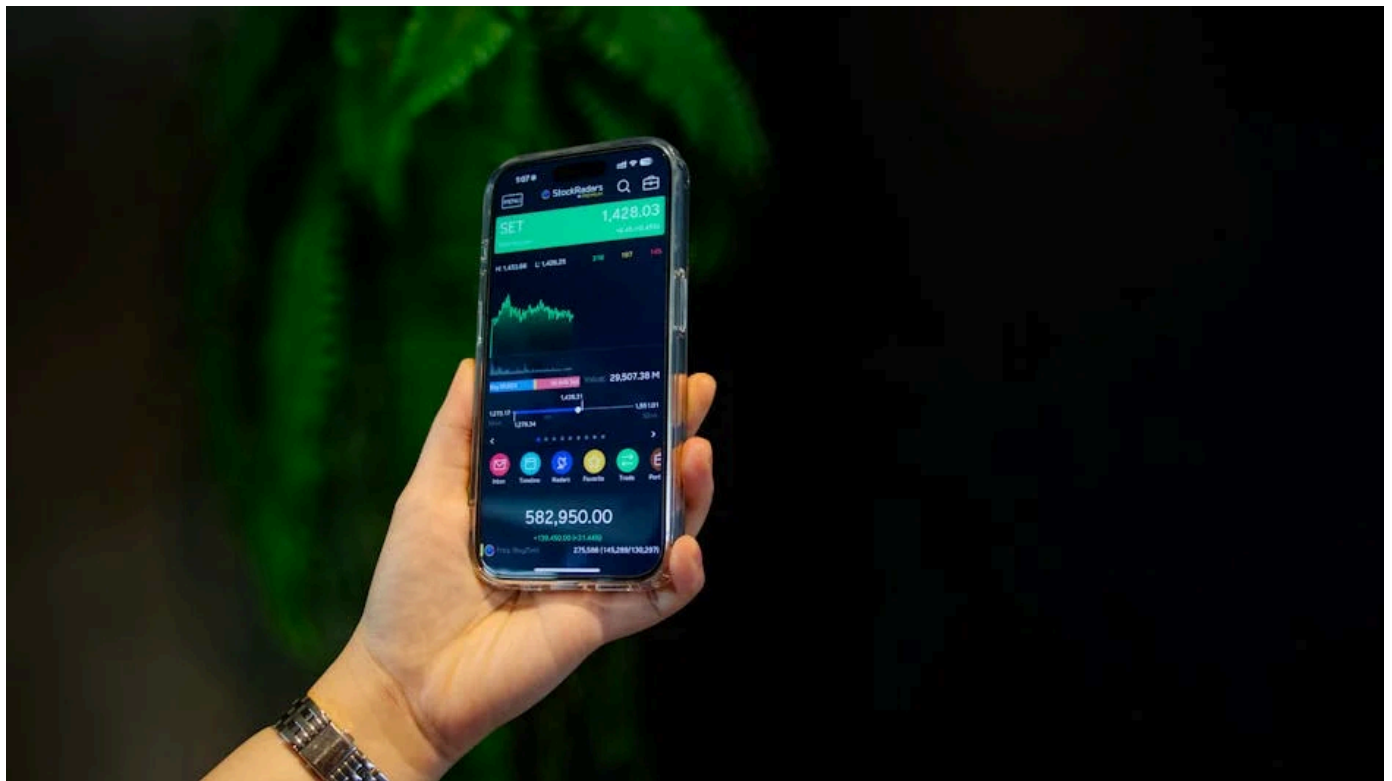
Source: <https://indianexpress.com/article/education/keep-neet-out-of-bpt-bot-admissions-as-it-is-devoid-of-logic-tn-cm-tells-pm-10493473/>

Budget, Fed Rate & Earnings: The Triple Threat Shaking Dalal Street!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Stock market is gearing up for an eventful week ahead where key triggers such as quarterly earnings from corporates, the US Fed interest rate decision and the upcoming Union Budget for 2026-27 would grab the limelight, analysts said.

Detailed analysis:

A confluence of corporate earnings, Fed policy and the Union Budget can cause high volatility. Aspirants should track earnings beats/misses, Fed rate outlook and key budget allocations to anticipate sectoral moves.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/stocks/news/q3-earnings-fed-rate-decision-budget-to-steer-dalal-street-this-week/articleshow/127457472.cms>

US Hints at Dropping 25% Tariff on India – A Trade Shockwave!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The US has hinted at removing the additional 25% tariff on India after New Delhi sharply cut Russian oil imports. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said India's purchases have "collapsed," calling the tariffs a success. Imports fell about 30% year-on-year in early January. India maintains its strategic autonomy even as Washington weighs tougher trade measures.

Detailed analysis:

Tariff rollback could lower import costs for Indian oil refiners and improve trade balance. Candidates should note the geopolitical link between Russia-India oil ties and US trade policy, and its possible impact on energy prices.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/economy/foreign-trade/us-signals-possible-rollback-of-25-tariff-on-india-as-russian-oil-imports-fall/articleshow/127414744.cms>

EU-India Free Trade Deal Set to Super-Charge Luxury EV Influx!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

India and the European Union are nearing a free trade agreement that could slash import duties on automobiles, including electric vehicles, to 10-15%. This move is anticipated to boost European luxury EV sales in India and position the country as a competitive manufacturing hub for these vehicles.

Detailed analysis:

Reduced duties will make EU luxury EVs more affordable, prompting a shift in consumer preferences and potentially spurring domestic EV ecosystem development. Watch for policy updates and related GST implications.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/renewables/india-eu-fta-likely-to-cut-auto-import-duties-may-spur-surge-in-luxury-ev-imports/articleshow/127412481.cms>

Pay Commission Firestorm: 3.25 Fitment Factor & 5% Raise Demanded!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

FNPO has said that the previous pay commissions did not apply the fitment factor consistently at all levels, both by design and necessity. Therefore, it has sought fitment factors ranging from 3.0-3.25 for various central government employee levels.

Detailed analysis:

Higher fitment factors translate to larger salary revisions for central govt staff, impacting fiscal outlay. Aspirants should assess how these demands affect the Union Budget and fiscal deficit projections.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/money/personal-finance/8th-pay-commission-employee-organisation-urges-fitment-factor-of-3-25-5-annual-increment-11769325955107.html>

Remote Work Alert: Short Stints in India Could Spark Unexpected Taxes!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

From overseas employees working briefly from India to gifting money to NRIs, here's how Indian tax rules apply in two common cross-border situations.

Detailed analysis:

Short-term remote work can create tax residency issues and trigger Indian income tax liability. Candidates must know the 182-day rule and tax treaty provisions to advise correctly.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/money/india-tax-implications-remote-work-non-resident-indian-salary-11769335581039.html>

AI Chatbots: The New Investment Gurus or Dangerous Money Traps?

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

While AI chatbots are a great tool to learn concepts, narrow down choices or even discover options, the risk lies in treating recommendations as advice. Action-oriented money decision-making driven by AI can be risky.

Detailed analysis:

AI-driven advice lacks fiduciary responsibility and may ignore individual risk profiles. Exam takers should stress the importance of due diligence, diversification, and professional counsel alongside technology.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/money/personal-finance/ai-chatbots-investment-advisor-risk-factor-ai-chatbot-financial-advice-11769157558229.html>

— ENVIRONMENT —

Delhi Zoo Scandal: CBI Probe Demanded as Wildlife Murder Mystery Unfolds!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Wildlife activist Ajay Dubey flagged a series of incidents at the Delhi Zoo, including the killing of wildlife, the illegal felling of trees, and the misuse of public funds

Detailed analysis:

Highlights governance lapses in wildlife management and public fund misuse—key topics for UPSC Environment & Forests. Illustrates the need for strong regulatory oversight and the role of institutions like CBI in environmental crimes.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/wildlife-activist-seeks-cbi-probe-into-irregularities-at-delhi-zoo/article70549558.ece>

Great Nicobar Disaster: Congress Blasts Centre Over Tribal Tragedy and Ecological Catastrophe!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Responding to allegations of coercion of tribal communities, former Environment Minister Jairam Ramesh says, “This is unacceptable and shows how the project is being bulldozed through. It is an ecological disaster”

Detailed analysis:

Exam-relevant for understanding tribal rights, large-scale development versus environmental sustainability, and political accountability—core issues in GS Paper-III and Ethics.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/congress-cites-the-hindu-report-to-target-centre-over-great-nicobar-project-calls-modi-government-indifferent/article70546583.ece>
